

OWNER'S GUIDE

Digits



Your private, end-to-end encrypted home telephone.
A **real phone** that makes **real calls**: no apps, no logins, no tracking.

★ GETTING STARTED ★

*Gutted, rewired, and brought back to life by hand.
A Justin Lindh contraption.*

01 Plugging in & powering on

Get the phone booted and ready

● SETUP

It's a real telephone. It makes real calls. That's it. Before your first call you'll plug the phone in, join it to your Wi-Fi once, and pair it with your account.

◆ What you'll need

Wi-Fi	A 2.4 GHz network with internet. The phone does not support 5 GHz-only networks.
A phone or laptop	For the one-time setup, and to pair the phone afterwards.
Your account	Sign in to the Digits app at <code>app.digits.family</code> to pair the phone and choose its number.



The status LED sits to the left of the keypad.

◆ Plug it in

- 1 Place the phone on a flat surface with the **handset resting on the cradle**.
- 2 Plug the power adapter into the port on the **back of the phone**.
- 3 Plug the other end into a wall outlet.
- 4 The red ● **LED** on the front blinks briefly as the phone boots.

i First boot takes 30–60 seconds. The phone is starting its internal computer. You'll know it's done when the red LED stops its boot flicker and settles into a steady pattern (see the table below).

◆ The LED while it starts up

For the first ~10 seconds the light shows the phone's last known state. In the strips below, ■ = lit, □ = dark; left → right is time.

LED pattern	Meaning
■■■■ Smooth breathing	Paired and working normally
■□□□ Brief flash every 1.7 s	Unpaired: waiting for a pairing code
■□□□ Two quick flashes, pause	In Wi-Fi setup mode
■□□□ Rapid blinking	Recovery mode or error
□□□□ Off	First boot (brand-new device)

Setup has two parts: first you join the phone to your Wi-Fi, then you pair it from the Digits app and pick its number. You only do this once.

◆ Step 1: Join the phone's hotspot

During setup your phone broadcasts its own temporary network. On your phone or laptop, join:

Digits-XXXX (no password needed)

The XXXX is four characters unique to your phone, so just pick the Digits- network from the list. Most devices pop a "Sign in to network" notification: tap it. If not, open a browser to <http://192.168.4.1>.

◆ Step 2: Enter your Wi-Fi details

The setup page loads automatically. Pick your home network, type its password, then tap **Connect**. That's all this page asks for.

The Wi-Fi setup page, shown in your phone or laptop's browser.

◆ Step 3: Wait for the reboot

The phone saves and restarts (~30 s). Reconnect your own device to your normal Wi-Fi. Your Digits phone is now on your network.

◆ Step 4: Pair the phone & pick your number

Now that it's online, the phone needs pairing to your account. **Lift the handset** and the phone reads out a **6-digit pairing code** aloud (it repeats, and a fresh code is issued every few minutes). Then, on your phone or laptop:

- 1 Open the Digits app at app.digits.family and sign in.
- 2 Go to **Lines**, then **Add a phone**, and type the 6-digit code the handset read out.
- 3 **Choose your line number** (format XXX-XXXX), name the handset, then tap **Pair**.

The **Add a phone** screen in the Digits app: type the spoken code, then choose your line number.

✓ **Setup is complete** once it's paired: pick up the handset and you'll hear a **dial tone**, a steady hum. That's the phone telling you it's online and ready.

03

Making & receiving calls

The whole point of the thing

CALLS

◆ Make a call

- 1 **Pick up the handset:** lift it off the cradle.
- 2 **Listen for the dial tone:** a steady hum means ready.
- 3 **Dial the 7-digit number.** e.g. **271-0001** → dial 2710001.
- 4 **Wait:** you'll hear ringing while their phone rings.
- 5 **Talk!** When they pick up, you're connected.

i No apps, no logins, no hold music. Just a phone call.

◆ Answer a call

- 1 **The bell rings:** a real mechanical bell.
- 2 **Pick up the handset.** That's it: you're connected.

◆ Hang up

- 1 **Place the handset back on the cradle.** The call ends immediately.

! **Don't leave the handset off the cradle.** The other person hears silence, and your phone can't receive new calls.

◆ What the tones mean

Sound	Meaning
Steady hum	Dial tone: ready to dial
Ringing (brrring... brrring...)	Their phone is ringing
Busy signal (fast beeping)	They're already on a call
Silence / error tone	Call couldn't connect: hang up and try again

Service codes are hidden shortcuts. Lift the handset, dial the code like a phone number, and the phone responds with a voice prompt or a beep.

◆ Volume

Code	Level
*#*0	Mute
*#*1	Quiet
*#*5	Medium
*#*9	Maximum

Dial ***#*** then any digit **0**–**9**. Saved across reboots.

◆ How the phone answers

Double beep	Volume changed; also the start & end of the audio test
Spoken prompt	Setup, re-pair, and factory reset ask you to press * to confirm
Silent	Reboot and shutdown make no beep; watch the LED instead

i The letter codes are mnemonics: SETUP=73887, TEST=8378 on the keypad.

◆ Other codes

Code	Also	What it does
*#8378#	*#TEST#	Audio test: records about 5 seconds and plays it back. Checks mic & earpiece.
*#73887#	*#SETUP#	Wi-Fi setup: reboots into setup mode (press * to confirm). Use it when your network changes.
##	–	Reboot: restarts the phone (about a minute).
##	–	Safe shutdown: powers off gracefully. Unplug after the LED goes dark.

◆ Call return: ***69** & ***89**

Dialed straight from dial tone (no ***#** prefix), just like a 1990s phone line.

- 1 Pick up and dial ***69**. A voice says: “The last call you received was from [number].”
- 2 Press **1** to call them back, or hang up to cancel.
- 3 If their line is busy, the phone keeps trying for 30 minutes and rings you with a **short-short-long** pattern when it's free: pick up and you're connected automatically.
- 4 To cancel a pending retry, pick up and dial ***89**.

When a call rings unanswered past the timeout, the phone picks up, plays your greeting, and records a message. Your handset mic stays muted while it records, so a caller never hears your room.

- **Message-waiting light.** When the phone is idle and you have an unheard message, the front LED gives a **slow pulse** instead of staying dark. A dark LED means no new messages.

◆ Listen: *98

Lift the handset and dial ***98**. The phone says how many new messages you have, then plays them oldest first. While a message plays:

Key	Action
7	Delete & go to next ("Message deleted")
9	Save & go to next ("Message saved")
#	Skip: stays new, you'll hear it again
*	Replay from the start

Letting a message finish marks it heard and keeps it. Only **7** deletes for good. Saved messages play after the new ones.

◆ Good to know

Storage	Keeps up to 50 messages. When full, the oldest is deleted to make room: clear messages regularly.
Message length	Ends when the caller hangs up (10-minute backstop cap).
Turning it on/off	Per line in the web app, along with the ring timeout (5–60 s before it picks up).

◆ Your greeting

Code	What it does
*96	Audition: hear your current greeting as callers hear it.
*97	Record: speak after the tone, press # when done ("Greeting saved"). Up to 60 s.
*99	Delete: remove your greeting, restore the standard one.

- i** Pick up while the greeting or recording plays and the phone hands you the live call: the machine steps aside.

Answering Machine

☐ Take messages when nobody answers

The handset auto-answers after the timeout, plays the greeting, and records the caller. Messages stay on the handset; dial the retrieval code from the phone to listen.

Ring timeout (seconds)

5 to 60 seconds before the answering machine picks up.

Turn voicemail on or off, and set the ring timeout, per line in the Digits app.

06

Party line: three-way calling
Classic '90s residential three-way

● 3-WAY

Add a third person to a call the old-fashioned way: with a **“flash.”** A flash is a quick press-and-release of the hook switch (the cradle button), 100–600 ms on-hook. Too short does nothing; too long hangs up.

◆ **How to do it**

Gesture	What happens
Flash during an active call	The person you're talking to drops to a silent hold; you hear a second dial tone
Dial a third number	You hear ringback; their phone rings
Flash again after they answer	All three are merged into one conversation
Flash before they answer	Drops the attempt; returns you to the held person
Anyone hangs up (host or guest)	The whole party line ends for all three; there is no drop back to a two-person call

i **Hard-capped at three people**, matching residential three-way calling on the old telephone switches.

 **Still fully encrypted.** A party-line call runs as three independent encrypted connections, mixed locally on each phone. The server never hears the audio: even with three people on the line.

◆ **Practising the flash**

It takes a moment to get the timing. Press the cradle button down and let it pop back up in well under a second: like tapping it. If the call ends, you held it too long. If nothing happens, you were too quick.

◆ LED indicator: normal operation

Once booted, the small red light shows what the phone is doing right now. Read each strip left → right as the blink pattern over time:

LED pattern	Meaning
 Off	Idle, on-hook: ready to receive calls
 Solid on	Handset off the cradle (dial tone or dialing)
 Smooth breathing	Active call in progress
 Blinking (~1/second)	Incoming call: pick up to answer
 Slow pulse	You have an unheard voicemail
 Brief flash every 1.7 s	Unpaired: pick up to hear your pairing code
 Rapid blinking	Something went wrong: try rebooting

◆ Privacy: built in, not bolted on

End-to-end encrypted calls. Voice is encrypted directly between the two phones. Not even the Digits network can listen.

No call recordings. Live calls are never recorded or stored. When a call ends, it's gone. (If you turn on voicemail, messages are saved only on your own phone, never on our servers.)

Hardware mic disconnect. When the handset rests on the cradle, the microphone is **physically disconnected**: an electrical cut, not a software mute. A phone on the hook cannot listen.

✓ **What we store:** your account, household, line assignments, and call metadata (who, when, how long).

✗ **What we never store:** voice audio, recordings, transcripts, or location. There is no mechanism in the server to capture call audio.

No dial tone when I pick up

Wait 60 s: it may still be booting. Check the power adapter (both ends) and that your Wi-Fi works. If the LED blinks rapidly and won't stop, reboot: dial ******* and wait ~60 s.

No dial tone after setup

The Wi-Fi password may be wrong. Dial ***#73887#** to re-enter setup. Make sure it's a **2.4 GHz** network: 5 GHz-only won't work.

Can't join the Digits-XXXX hotspot

The hotspot is only on in setup mode. If already set up, dial ***#73887#** first. On some devices, "forget" old networks or toggle Wi-Fi off/on.

Setup page didn't load

Wait 10–15 s after joining for the captive-portal prompt. Otherwise open a browser to <http://192.168.4.1>. Confirm you're on Digits-XXXX, not your home network.

Bell rings but no one's there

The caller likely hung up before you answered. Confirm your number with whoever's calling.

Call sounds bad / echoey

Set a lower volume level (try *****3**; *****0–***9** set the level directly). Run the audio test (***#8378#**) and listen back. Move the phone away from the Wi-Fi router if they're touching.

Not ringing for incoming calls

Make sure the handset is fully seated on the cradle: slightly off and the phone thinks you're using it. The idle LED should be off.

Need to change Wi-Fi network

Dial ***#73887#** (***#SETUP#**) while off-hook. The phone reboots into setup mode; follow the Wi-Fi steps on page 3.

i Still stuck? Visit digits.family or email support@digits.family. Mention your line number and what the LED is doing.

**09**

Recovery mode

The safety net for when the phone gets stuck

[HELP](#)

Recovery mode is a safety net. If the phone can't start up normally, it drops into recovery so you can restart it or, as a last resort, reset it. You'll know you're in recovery because the status  **LED blinks rapidly** and won't settle.

◆ How the phone gets here

By itself After several failed start-ups in a row, or if its storage is damaged, the phone enters recovery automatically.

On purpose Hold the  key while you plug the phone in, and keep holding until the LED blinks rapidly.

◆ Two ways to fix it

From the handset. Lift it to hear a short menu:

-  Restart and try a normal start-up again
-  Factory reset (press  again to confirm)

From a phone or laptop. Join the [Digits-Recovery](#) network (no password) and a page opens with **Try Again** and **Factory Reset**. If it doesn't pop up, browse to <http://192.168.4.1>.

i Try Restart first. Most of the time the phone just needs a clean reboot, which keeps all your settings. Reach for factory reset only if restarting doesn't get you a dial tone.

! Factory reset erases everything: your Wi-Fi, pairing, voicemail, and settings. The phone returns to its out-of-the-box state, and you set it up again from scratch (Wi-Fi and pairing on page 3).

DIGITS QUICK REFERENCE

Digits

◆ Everyday

Make a call	Pick up → dial 7 digits
Answer	Pick up when the bell rings
Hang up	Handset on the cradle
Three-way	Flash → dial → flash to merge

◆ Voicemail

*98	Listen to messages
*97	Record your greeting
*96	Hear your greeting

◆ Codes

***0 - 9	Volume (mute → max)
*#8378#	Audio test
*#73887#	Wi-Fi setup
***#	Reboot
***#	Shutdown
*69 / *89	Call return / cancel

◆ The light

	Off	Idle, ready
	On	In use
	Blink	Incoming call
	Pulse	New voicemail

My number

____ - ____

Setup hotspot

Digits - _____